



Nintendo

Talking about Nintendo's influence

in gaming is like talking about Steve Job's influence in the making of the iPod. But for a company that initially tried running aham "Love Hotels", did incredible feats in the gaming industry. It's known for legendary titles such as super Super Mario brothers, Donkey Kong as well as consoles such as the NES (Nintendo Entertainment System) and GameBoy handheld. Later on Nintendo went on to create the Nintendo DS and Nintendo Wii which completely changed the way people played games. Joysticks and D-pads became old news, and overnight video-games became a thing to do for almost everyone.



It wasn't just teenagers who were gaming now, suddenly older people started hosting Wii themed house parties and doddery grandmas were playing tennis in their living rooms. Ok we're exaggerating a little but you get the idea.

\$1,000,000,000

Is the amount most analysts estimate Blizzard makes annually in revenue from World of Warcraft. Considering Blizzard made around \$250 million in 2005, estimates suggest that currently it makes around \$1 billion from its subscriberf 11.5 million users.

Exergaming



A mix of Exercise and Gaming that finally got couch potatoes to drop their gamepads and move their a**

without compromising on their daily fix of video game entertainment. Motion gaming completely upturned the earlier ideology that gaming makes people sedentary. It's roots lie in rudimentary kits like Power Pad for Nintendo Entertainment System and Arcade games

like Dance Dance Revolution. But the genre really came into major spotlight with the release of Nintendo's Wii (and its peripherals) when motion gaming as a whole revolutionised the way games are played. What followed was Playstation Move and Xbox Kinect, together taking gaming in the living room to all members of the family not just the young people. But is it just limited to fitness and sports themed games? Not quite. Even mainstreams game franchises are soon going to bite in on the action. BioShock Infinite is slated to have support for PS Move while the Kinect will play nice with the upcoming Halo CE. A port of Arkham Asylum is also rumoured to be under development for the recently unveiled Wii U. So in the end, the take away is pretty obvious - "We like to move it move it!"



World of Warcraft

What WoW did was to take what was thought of by most as "hardcore" to what now is thought of as an everyday thing. Millions of non-gamers worldwide have now become addicted to this as a way of life. We're pretty sure you've

heard of people dying after 48 hours of continuous gaming, or people getting married in-game, etc. Apart from all this silliness, the Corrupted Blood Incident for instance was used by Epidemiologists to study the spread of diseases. It was a game glitch that players intentionally exploited in 2005. It gave scientists clues to how humans would behave when infected with a disease.



Counter Strike

Surprise surprise! We couldn't have wrapped up with a gaming A to Z round-up without talking about Counter Strike, right? In India, at least, CS is as much a part of popular culture as it is simply a product. Essentially a Half-life mod developed by Minh "Gooseman" Le and Jess "Cliffe" Cliffe, the game quickly became a part of international

gaming tournaments. Clans formed and there are people in the world who make a living out of playing CS professionally. On the flip-side there are whispers of CS provoking crazed gun massacres, leading to bans and all round parental outrage. Yet most of us just want to get our hands on Global Offensive which is scheduled to be released early next year. Fire in the hole!

